

Purpose: To help us recognize that the gospel is for all people and that the Church is guided by continuing revelation.

1. Peter learns in a vision that the gospel should be preached to the Gentiles.

- Read and discuss [Acts 10:1—11:18](#).

• Acts 1: 1-8, 30-31. “2 A devout man ... that feared God ... which gave much alms ... and prayed to God always.”

What kind of man was Cornelius? †1. Acts 10:1-8. An Angel Instructed Cornelius

Why is it important to act immediately on instructions or promptings from God?

- Acts 10: 9-16. “As they went on their journey ... Peter went up upon the housetop to pray”.

What did Peter see? What was Peter told to do? Why did Peter resist? How did the Lord respond to Peter?

†2. Acts 10:9-33. Peter Chosen to Introduce the Gospel to the Gentiles

Why were the Gentiles represented in the dream by unclean animals?

- Acts 10:28, 34-35. “But God hath shewed me that I should not call any man common or unclean... in every nation ...”

- Acts 10:36-43. What did Peter teach Cornelius and those with him?

- Acts 10:44-48. “While Peter yet spake these words, the Holy Ghost fell on all of them which heard the word.”

- Acts 11:1-3. “The apostles and brethren that were in Judaea heard that the Gentiles had also received the word of God.”

Why were some of these members upset?

- Acts 11:4-18. Peter recounts the story and “When they heard these things, they held their peace, and glorified God”.

When we receive difficult instructions from our Church leaders, how should we respond?

(See [John 7:17](#); [2 Nephi 28:30](#); and [D&C 6:11, 14-15](#).)

Why is it important to have only one person who receives revelation for the entire Church? (See [D&C 43:2-6](#).)

2. Peter is miraculously freed from prison.

- Read and discuss [Acts 12](#).

- Acts 12:1-11, 18-19. Herod cast Peter in prison “but prayer was made without ceasing of the church ... for him.”

How can our prayers help the prophet and other Church leaders today? (See [D&C 43:12](#); [93:51](#); [107:22](#).)

†3. President Joseph F. Smith

When has the Lord miraculously preserved someone’s life until his or her earthly mission was completed?

- Acts 12:21-24. Herod spoke and the people said “It is the voice of a god,” and the angel smote him because ...”

How have you seen the Church flourish despite the efforts of some people to destroy it?

3. Saul (now known as Paul) and Barnabas preach the gospel to the Gentiles.

- Read and discuss [Acts 13-14](#).

- Acts 13:1-3. “As they ... fasted, the Holy Ghost said, Separate me Barnabas and Saul for the work”.

Why are prayer and fasting, revelation, and priesthood authority important in calling members to serve?

What experiences have helped you know that Church callings are inspired of the Lord?

- Acts 13:13-14, 23-31, 38-41. Synagogue leaders in Antioch to Paul and Barnabas, “if ye have any word ... say on.”

- Acts 13:42-44, 48. The “Gentiles besought that these words might be preached to them the next Sabbath.”

- Acts 13:45-47. “But when the Jews saw the multitudes, they were filled with envy, and spake against” Paul’s words.

- Acts 14:8-13, 14-18. Paul healed a cripple and people said, “The gods are come down to us in the likeness of men.”

- Acts 14:1-6, 19. Certain “Jews from Antioch and Iconium ... having stoned Paul”.

- Acts 14:21-23. They returned to each city “Confirming ... the disciples, and exhorting them to continue” etc.

What can we do to support new members of our ward or branch? †4. President Gordon B. Hinckley

4. The Apostles determine that Gentiles do not need to keep the law of Moses.

- Read and discuss [Acts 15:1-35](#).

- Acts 15:1-2. Some members said, “Except ye be circumcised ... ye cannot be saved.”

†5. Circumcision †6. Circumcision—Bible Dictionary

How do the events in Acts 15:6-31 demonstrate how Church policy and practices are made?

†7. How Church-wide decisions are made

Next Week: L31 “And So Were the Churches Established in the Faith”; See L30: [Class Member Study Guide](#).

Read the Institute New Testament Student Manual at: [New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212](#).) † •

NT30 Quotes

†1. Acts 10:1-8. An Angel Instructed Cornelius:

“Cornelius was a Roman centurion living in Caesarea. He was a Gentile, who was described as being God-fearing, devout, generous, and prayerful. An angel appeared to Cornelius and instructed him to send for Peter, who was then in Joppa. This vision was the first of several events that would culminate in the gospel being preached to the Gentiles, **whereas previously only Jews had been admitted into the Church.**” (NTSM: Rel. 211-212, [Chapter 31: Acts 8-12](#). Scroll down to Acts 10 commentary.)

†2. Acts 10:9-33. Peter Chosen to Introduce the Gospel to the Gentiles:

“Though Peter did not at first understand the meaning of the vision, he soon came to understand that **the time had come for Gentiles to be baptized into the Church without first converting to Judaism.** This revelation regarding Gentile converts came to Peter because he was the chief Apostle of the day, and he held priesthood keys for the entire Church (see Matthew 16:18–19). Revelation for the entire Church is always given through proper channels (see [D&C 28:2, 6–7; 43:1–7](#)).” (NTSM: Rel. 211-212, [Chapter 31: Acts 8-12](#). Scroll down to Acts 10 commentary. See also NT30 Enrichment.pdf †1. Cornelius.)

†3. **President Joseph F. Smith:** “There never should be a day pass but all of the people composing the Church should lift up their voices in prayer to the Lord to sustain his servants” (Gospel Doctrine, 5th ed. [1939], 223).

†4. **President Gordon B. Hinckley:** “With the ever increasing number of converts, we must make an increasingly substantial effort to assist them as they find their way. Every one of them needs three things: a friend, a responsibility, and nurturing with ‘the good word of God’ (Moroni 6:4). It is our duty and opportunity to provide these things” (“[Converts and Young Men](#),” Ensign, May 1997, 47).

†5. **Circumcision:** “Circumcision was symbolic of the entire law of Moses. A circumcised man was one who kept the law. Although Jesus Christ had fulfilled the law of Moses, some Jewish Christians still practiced it and wanted Gentile converts to practice it as well.” (*Lesson Manual*)

†6. **Circumcision—Bible Dictionary:** “There was much controversy in the early church with regard to the obligation of circumcision (Acts 15:1–31). The Church under direction of Peter and the Twelve, and acting under the guidance of the Spirit, declared that circumcision was not obligatory for gentile converts. However, it apparently did not settle the matter of whether or not Jewish members of the Church should have their children circumcised. As one reads the scriptures on the matter, it becomes evident that the real issue was not circumcision only but also the larger question as to continued observance of the law of Moses by members of the Church. The word circumcision seems to have been representative of the law in these instances. The controversy was renewed later on in Galatia, as we read in Gal. 2:1–15; 5:2–6, 11; 6:12–16. These passages, along with Rom. 2:25–29; 3:1–2; Philip. 3:3; and Col. 2:11, contain Paul’s teaching on the subject.” (Bible Dictionary—“[Circumcision](#)”)

†7. How Church-wide decisions are made:

- a. Church leaders meet to consider the matter (verse 6).
- b. They discuss the matter thoroughly (verses 7-21).
- c. They make a decision in accordance with the Lord’s will (verses 19-21).
- d. The Holy Ghost confirms that the decision is correct (verse 28).
- e. The decision is announced to the Saints for sustaining (verses 22-31).

Recommended Reading:

1. [NT30 Enrichment.pdf](#) contains more quotes and links to articles, blogs, and talks.
2. *New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, [Chapter 31: Acts 8-12](#). Scroll down to Acts 10 commentary.
3. *New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, [Chapter 32: Acts 13-15](#).

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